



Shankar Binjawadgi

AI-First Technical Product Manager

EX-AWS PMT-ES · EX-MICROSOFT AZURE · UW FOSTER STEM MBA '26

Portfolio website - [smb007.xyz](#)

Who I Am

Hi 🙋, I'm Shankar — an AI-first Technical Product Manager who brings curiosity, technical depth, product taste, and grit to ambiguous problems. I enjoy product work that starts with a messy human problem, moves through disciplined discovery, and ends in a clear strategy, prototype, or roadmap that helps cross-functional teams build simple, scalable products customers adopt and trust.

Outside product work, I'm usually hiking, working out, or trying to understand why people behave the way they do.

What have I been building?

A snapshot of a few products and prototypes I've built, tested, and shaped across AI, consumer, and community experiences.



StreakFit

APR 2026 - ONGOING

Discovered 3 student fitness pain points through 6 interviews (hypotheses driven); built a 0-to-1 personalized AI gym buddy MVP in 3 hours at OpenAI Codex Hackathon; currently iterating toward a broader release based on user feedback.



HeyLily AI Scam-Call Assistant

JAN 2026 - MAR 2026

Led an 11-member cross-functional team across design, engineering, and business to build HeyLily, a Hiya competitor and AI scam-call assistant for seniors. Ran 15+ user interviews, guided development of an android call app, and crafted a 5-year B2B2C go-to-market model.



Spotify AI MiniMix

SEP 2025 - ONGOING

Built an AI music recommendation engine in n8n for mood and occasion sub-playlist curation, using dynamic song-feature selection and improving relevance by 73% versus a rule-based baseline in project testing.



AI Hike Researcher

JAN 2026 - ONGOING

Interviewed 2 hike organizers to identify planning pain points; architected AI Hike Researcher, a cost and time efficient AI agent that gathers 6 real-time safety signals and personalizes trail filtering, reducing weekly planning time by 98%.



Product Teardown Series

SEP 2025 - MAR 2026

Ideated, launched, and ran the Foster Tech Club program that made product thinking more social and hands-on; created event marketing, posters, Luma pages, and audience messaging; produced three teardown events with 110+ attendees.



Bumble Barney AI Wingman

FEB 2023

Analyzed 100 one-star Bumble App Store ratings, root-caused the recurring no-matches problem, brainstormed solutions, and proposed Bumble Barney, an AI wingman intended to decrease no matches by 10%. Won 2nd rank in the February NextLeap Capstone project.



What do I bring to the table?



Customer & Behavioral Psychology

Understanding how users think, struggle, decide, and adopt products.



AI-First Product Building

Using AI to rethink workflows, reduce friction, and create new product experiences.



Data-Driven Product Judgment

Turning customer signals, usage patterns, and business context into better product decisions.



Strategic Business Acumen

Connecting market needs, company goals, competitor research, financial tradeoffs, and go-to-market realities into product decisions that create durable business value.



Technical Depth

Working credibly with engineering teams across cloud infrastructure, distributed systems, scalability, and reliability.



Cross-Functional Collaboration

Aligning engineering, design, business, and customer stakeholders around clear problems and measurable outcomes.

What’s my modus operandi?



Agency

Driven, high ownership, comfort with ambiguity, proactive problem-solving, and outcome-focused execution.



Human-Centered

Listening for signals, understanding motivations, mentorship, and collaborative alignment.



Thoughtful

Deliberate thinking, simplicity, attention to detail, and long-term orientation.



MANAGER NOTE

“It was a lot of **fun** having you on the team this summer, and it was a really cool project! Your **ownership** and **bias for action** were amazing. Thank you Shankar!”



Rick Ochs
Senior Manager at AWS, Cloud Optimization

2026 SR. PRODUCT MANAGER TECHNICAL - EXTERNAL SERVICE INTERNSHIP @ AWS

What I can geek out on

-  Behavioral psychology
-  Hiking
-  Gym
-  Poker
-  Anime

Where I Worked



Jun 2025 - Sep 2025

Senior Product Manager Technical, AWS FinOps

Amazon Web Services

Seattle, WA

Worked on AWS FinOps cost optimization strategy, customer discovery, roadmap prioritization, and PRFAQ-style product definition.



Jul 2021 - Jul 2024

Technical Product Builder 2, Azure Core Storage

Microsoft

Bangalore, India

Led Azure Core Storage product and engineering work across Blob NFS, AI incident diagnosis, distributed caching, and high-throughput infrastructure for enterprise and HPC workloads.

2 projects



Jul 2018 - Jul 2020

Software Engineer, Azure Core Monitor & Migrate

Microsoft

Hyderabad, India

Built Azure Monitor and Migrate product experiences and cloud infrastructure improvements across UX, performance, cost, reliability, and disaster recovery.

What I Studied



Sep 2024 - Mar 2026

Master of Business Administration (MBA), Management Science (STEM)

Foster School of Business, University of Washington

Seattle, WA

VP of Foster Tech Club and AI Product Builder, focused on product strategy, customer research, AI prototyping, go-to-market thinking, and product leadership.

10 projects



Feb 2023

Product Management Fellowship

NextLeap

Bangalore, India

Selected as a Top Fellow with 2nd rank in NextLeap's Product Management Fellowship, focused on structured product thinking, customer pain-point analysis, and capstone problem solving.

4 projects



Sep 2018 - Dec 2018

Advanced AI/ML Certification (ML & Deep Learning)

IIIT Hyderabad

Hyderabad, India

Completed an advanced AI/ML certification focused on machine learning and deep learning, placing 2nd in the capstone project.

1 project



Aug 2014 - Jun 2018

Bachelor of Engineering, Computer Science

PES University

Bangalore, India

Graduated with a 9.5 CGPA, ranked in the top 5% of the class.

1 project

How to Contact Me

Liked my work, have an idea to collaborate on, or just want to geek out on any of my interests? I'd be happy to hear from you. ☕

